



Shaky hands here. Can you even make out the street lights?



Shaky hands can give a poor motion-like effect to your pics

camera during exposure.

■ **A dirty lens:** Blow and brush off the debris with an air brush. Then clean the lens using a photographic microfibre cloth or a photo cleaning solution and photo lens wipes.

Lens Fungus

Problem: If you live in a humid region—which is the case in most of India, especially in the rainy season—moisture trapped inside the camera provides a good environment for fungus to grow, causing cloudiness and vein-like patterns to form in the lens.

Solution: Don't leave your camera in a camera bag when you're not out shooting. Store it in a cool, dry place. Keep your camera and lens in an airtight container with some bags of silica gel—these will absorb moisture. Make sure to change the bags regularly.

If you go out shooting in the cold, wrap your camera in a plastic bag before bringing it into a warm room to prevent moisture from accumulating inside the camera.

If fungus has already formed, you'll have to get your lens cleaned. Leaving your lens in the sun won't solve

the problem. Send the camera to the manufacturer or a repair shop for a professional cleaning.

You Deleted Your Photos By Mistake!

Problem: This is self-explanatory—you pressed the 'delete' button on your digicam by mistake, and now all your photos seem to have disappeared.

Solution: You may indeed be able to recover your photos. It's not 100 per cent guaranteed, but it could be that the photos just aren't getting detected, and are still there on the memory card.

You can try and use various software to recover the pictures. But remember not to format the card or take any more pictures before you recover the images you seem to have lost.

Software to recover images from a memory card include the following:

- Zero Assumption Digital Image Recovery 1.2
- MediaRecover 3.0
- MediaSaver 3.0.7.1
- Digital Photo Recovery 2.0.3

Your Batteries Don't Last Long Enough

Problem: Of course, battery life varies depending on the make and model of your camera, but you know you have a problem when even brand-new batteries afford just a few shots.

Solution: Use the correct AA cells (if

your camera uses these). Alkaline AA cells last much less than rechargeable NiMH cells or disposable lithium cells. If you find a specialty store which gives you cells of different mAh ratings, look for higher mAh ratings. As an indicator, 1850 mAh is good. Look for 1850 mAh or higher.

However, if your camera works on a Li-ion cell and was installed with a rechargeable one when you bought it, and it's still giving short battery life even on a full charge, there's something wrong with either the cell or the camera. Take them back to the store.

There Are Dark Specks On Your Photos

Problem: You might notice that after you changed your SLR's lens, your photos have brownish or blackish specks on them. This could happen if dust settled on the sensor when you changed the lens.

Solution: As always, there are two solutions: give the camera for professional cleaning, or clean the sensor yourself. Of course, you need to remember that if you're cleaning it yourself, you've got to be very, very careful. This is because sensors are covered by protective glass—and if you end up scratching the glass, your warranty will not help.

You can try and use cleaners made specifically for cleaning sensors. Companies such as Photographic Solutions make them. Also, Kodak sells a sensor-cleaning kit while providing detailed instructions on how to clean Kodak sensors.

If you've decided to clean the sensor yourself, get the camera into sensor-cleaning mode so the sensor is exposed. You'll need to check your manual for how to do this with your model. Remove the lens. Use a bulb blower to blow dust off the sensor—and while you're doing this, make sure you hold the camera such that the dust falls away and doesn't settle back on the sensor.

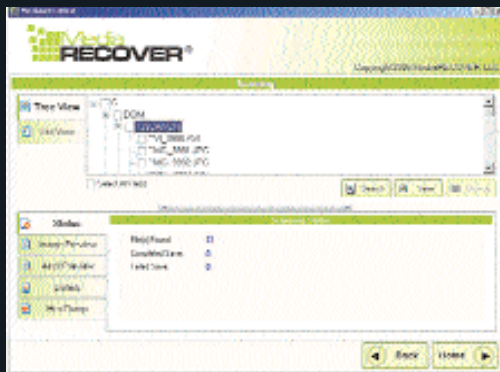
Carefully swab the surface of the sensor's protective glass.

Once you're done, click a picture of a white wall, for example. If you haven't done the cleaning perfectly, some dark specks will still show up.

VisibleDust

(www.visibledust.com) has products to help you safely clean your digicam's sensor. L. L. Rue (www.rue.com/cleaning.html) has cleaning aids for all kinds of photographic equipment, and they also feature a large bulb blower. Check it out! ■

ram_mohan@thinkdigit.com



MediaRecover has an easy interface that helps you recover lost pictures from your memory card